WEEK 2 · LESSON 11 OF 24 · HANDOUT

Checking AI's Work

Study time: **about 40 minutes** (reading, video and activity)

▶ **Watch:** https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=iOklnPvvDUo — open the lesson online to watch inside the course.

🎓 **Go deeper:** CS50 Tech Talk: Why You're Still Better Than AI at Editing Documents — https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=FqB_4QY6x6g

Your goal in this lesson: Verify AI output using a simple checking routine, check facts, numbers and sources, and know when to stop trusting an answer.

Why checking is the most valuable AI skill

Anyone can type a question. The professional difference is **knowing what to check and how**. One wrong figure in a report or one invented reference in an assignment can cost more time and trust than AI ever saved.

The C-H-E-C-K routine

Step	What to do
Claims	Underline every fact, number, date, name and quote in the answer.
Hunt for sources	Ask the AI for its sources, then open them yourself.
External check	Confirm important claims in a trusted source: official websites (gov.rw, RDB, RRA, NISR), textbooks, your organisation's documents.
Calculate	Re-do important numbers with a calculator or spreadsheet.
Keep or cut	Keep what you confirmed; correct or delete what you could not.

Trusted sources for Rwanda

- **Official government sites** for laws, procedures and services (ministries, Irembo, RDB, RRA).
- **NISR** (National Institute of Statistics of Rwanda) for official statistics.
- **Your institution's documents** for internal rules and data.
- **Peer-reviewed research** and recognised textbooks for academic work.

A popular blog or a social-media post is **not** enough to confirm an important claim.

Ways to make AI help you check

- *"List every factual claim in your answer and how confident you are in each."*
- *"Which parts of this answer might be out of date?"*
- *"Give me the official sources I should use to verify this."*
- *"Here is the official text. Does your summary match it? List any differences."*

The last one is powerful: **give the AI the trusted document** and ask it to work only from that.

Red flags — stop and verify

- Exact statistics with no source.
- References you cannot find.
- Legal, medical or financial advice presented as certain.
- Information that "sounds right" but you have never seen before.
- Different answers each time you ask.

How much checking is enough?

Match the effort to the risk. A brainstorming list needs a quick read. A report to your manager, an assignment or anything published needs **every claim checked**.

Remember this: Use the C-H-E-C-K routine — Claims, Hunt for sources, External check, Calculate, Keep or cut — before any AI-assisted work leaves your hands.

Name: _____ Date: _____

Activity

Task 1

Ask an AI assistant: *"Give me 5 key facts about Rwanda's economy with numbers."*

Task 2

Apply C-H-E-C-K: underline each claim, find an official or reliable source for each (for example NISR or a recent official report), and re-check any calculation.

Task 3

Make a table: claim — source found — correct / partly correct / wrong.

Task 4

Write one sentence about what you will always check from now on.

Self-check

Think about your answers here, then take the quiz online — it is marked instantly and explains every answer.

1. In the C-H-E-C-K routine, what does the first C stand for?
   - A. Confirm
   - B. Calculate
   - C. Claims
   - D. Copy
2. Which is the most trustworthy source to confirm an official statistic about Rwanda?
   - A. The AI's own answer
   - B. The National Institute of Statistics of Rwanda (NISR)
   - C. A popular social-media post
   - D. A random blog
3. What is a powerful way to reduce hallucinations when summarising a law or policy?
   - A. Give the AI the official document and ask it to work only from that
   - B. Use a shorter prompt
   - C. Ask the question in capital letters
   - D. Ask the AI to guess
4. Which is a RED FLAG that you must verify an answer?
   - A. The answer is polite
   - B. Exact statistics given without any source
   - C. The answer is in English
   - D. The answer uses bullet points
5. How much checking does a report going to your manager need?
   - A. A quick skim
   - B. Every important claim checked
   - C. None
   - D. Only the title
6. What should you do with a claim you could NOT confirm?
   - A. Move it to the end
   - B. Keep it because the AI sounded sure
   - C. Make it bold
   - D. Correct it or remove it

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